

MARIIA (MARIA) SOKOLOVA

Learning & Development Specialist / Instructional Designer

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Learning and development specialist with five years of experience, including two and a half years running L&D end to end for a B2B distributor: needs analysis, course design, production, and LMS administration. Built and maintain the training program for 350+ sales managers across Russia and the CIS. Background in ESL teaching, which shapes how I structure content for adult learners. English C1, native Russian.

CORE SKILLS

Instructional design (ADDIE) · E-learning development (iSpring Suite, SCORM) · LMS administration · Course and curriculum design · Learning analytics · Staff training and facilitation · Assessment design · MS PowerPoint, Canva

EXPERIENCE

Digital Learning Specialist — Complex Bar, Moscow, Russia Dec 2023 – Present

B2B distributor of glassware and bar equipment for the HoReCa industry (bars, restaurants, hotels).

- Built 35+ training assets — 15 SCORM e-learning courses and 20 structured longreads — covering product knowledge (glassware, bar equipment, syrups, inventory) for 350+ sales managers across Russia and the CIS.
- Designed the certification system: knowledge tests, case studies, situational scenarios.
- Run the company LMS solo — uploading content, managing the course catalog, tracking completion and progress.
- Organize in-person and online training sessions for regional sales teams.
- Build training material in parallel with new product launches, so reps are ready by the time a new product line ships.
- Identified that sales reps had no single place to check new product info, then designed and built an internal site (cbnew.complexbar.ru) to solve it — planned the structure, wrote the content, built it with AI-assisted coding tools, and worked with IT on server deployment. Ran a focus group with managers to test it before rollout.

English Teacher — "YES" English Club, Peresvet, Russia Sep 2021 – Jul 2023

- Designed learning programs for students aged 5 to 14.
- Taught regular lessons and ran extracurricular activities.
- Created teaching materials and learning games adapted to different levels.

English Teacher — School No. 1329, Moscow, Russia Oct 2020 – Jun 2021

- Worked one-on-one with students: built individual learning paths, adapted materials, tracked progress.

English Teacher — Skyeng, Remote Sep 2019 – Jan 2020

- Taught English online to students of different ages and levels; reviewed homework and tracked progress.

EDUCATION

Professional Graduate Certificate in Education, Teacher Development — UCL Institute of Education, University of London, London, UK 2022 – 2023

BA (Hons), Education — English Language and Educational Technology — Moscow Pedagogical State University, Moscow, Russia 2018 – 2023
GPA 4.9 / 5.0

CERTIFICATIONS

- E-learning Course Developer (Pro: Design) — iSpring Academy, 2024
- ESL Certificate — American Language Center, Moldova, 2023
- Montessori Method of Teaching — CPD Certification Service, 2023

LANGUAGES

Russian — native | English — C1, advanced | Spanish — A2, basic